

Daily Bible Note

Date: August 20, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Ezekiel 43:13-27

13 "These are the measurements of the altar in cubits (the cubit is one cubit and a handbreadth): the base one cubit high and one cubit wide, with a rim all around its edge of one span. This is the height of the altar:

14 from the base on the ground to the lower ledge, two cubits; the width of the ledge, one cubit; from the smaller ledge to the larger ledge, four cubits; and the width of the ledge, one cubit.

15 The altar hearth is four cubits high, with four horns extending upward from the hearth.

16 The altar hearth is twelve cubits long, twelve wide, square at its four corners;

17 the ledge, fourteen cubits long and fourteen wide on its four sides, with a rim of half a cubit around it; its base, one cubit all around; and its steps face toward the east."

18 And He said to me, "Son of man, thus says the Lord God: 'These are the ordinances for the altar on the day when it is made, for sacrificing burnt offerings on it, and for sprinkling blood on it.

19 You shall give a young bull for a sin offering to the priests, the Levites, who are of the seed of Zadok, who approach Me to minister to Me,' says the Lord God.

20 'You shall take some of its blood and put it on the four horns of the altar, on the four corners of the ledge, and on the rim around it; thus you shall cleanse it and make atonement for it.

21 Then you shall also take the bull of the sin offering, and burn it in the appointed place of the temple, outside the sanctuary.

22 On the second day you shall offer a kid of the goats without blemish for a sin offering; and they shall cleanse the altar, as they cleansed it with the bull.

23 When you have finished cleansing it, you shall offer a young bull without blemish, and a ram from the flock without blemish.

24 When you offer them before the Lord, the priests shall throw salt on them, and they will offer them up as a burnt offering to the Lord.

25 Every day for seven days you shall prepare a goat for a sin offering; they shall also prepare a young bull and a ram from the flock, both without blemish.

26 Seven days they shall make atonement for the altar and purify it, and so consecrate it.

27 When these days are over it shall be, on the eighth day and thereafter, that the priests shall offer your burnt offerings and your peace offerings on the altar; and I will accept you,' says the Lord God."

II. Key Summary

- Verses 13-17 measure the altar piece by piece: the base, the ledges, and the hearth, each layer narrower than the one below it. The hearth is twelve cubits long and twelve wide, square at its four corners, with horns on all four corners, and its steps face east.

- Verses 18-24 give the ordinances for the day the altar is made: priests of the seed of Zadok offer a young bull as a sin offering, put its blood on the four horns of the altar, the four corners of the ledge, and the rim around it to cleanse it, and burn the bull outside the sanctuary. On the second day a goat is offered, then a young bull and a ram as a burnt offering, with salt thrown on them.

- Verses 25-27 record that for seven days a sin offering and a burnt offering are made daily to purify the altar and consecrate it. Only when those days are over, on the eighth day and thereafter, do the priests offer burnt offerings and peace offerings on it, and the Lord God says, "I will accept you."

III. Passage Analysis

Getting clean takes time

"Basic to the action described here is the aim of setting the altar apart for its holy function and cleansing it from every taint of the secular, a process which takes a full seven days." [1]

The altar could not be used the moment it was built. Seven straight days of offerings had to cleanse it first, and only after that did the normal offerings begin. God's order is clear:

cleansed first, then used.

God accepts the person before the offering

"Those that give themselves to God shall be accepted of God, their persons first and then their performances, through the Mediator." [2]

After the seven days of cleansing, what God says is "I will accept you." The one being accepted is the person bringing the offering, and what is in their hands is accepted along with them.

IV. Reflection Question

In your mind, what does God look at when He accepts a person?

At the end of the passage God says, "I will accept you" — the person is accepted first and the offering in their hands is accepted along with them, and this comes through the Mediator, not through anything a person can do for themselves.

References

[1] Enduring Word (David Guzik), quoting Alexander,
<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/ezekiel-43/>

[2] Blue Letter Bible, Matthew Henry's Commentary,
https://www.blueletterbible.org/Comm/mhc/Eze/Eze_043.cfm